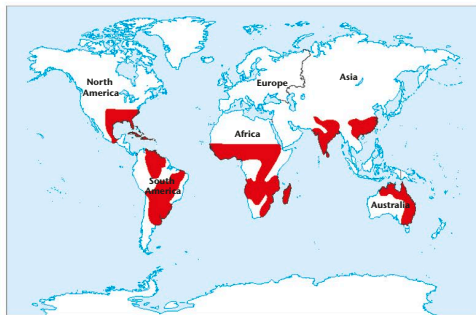


Monsoon

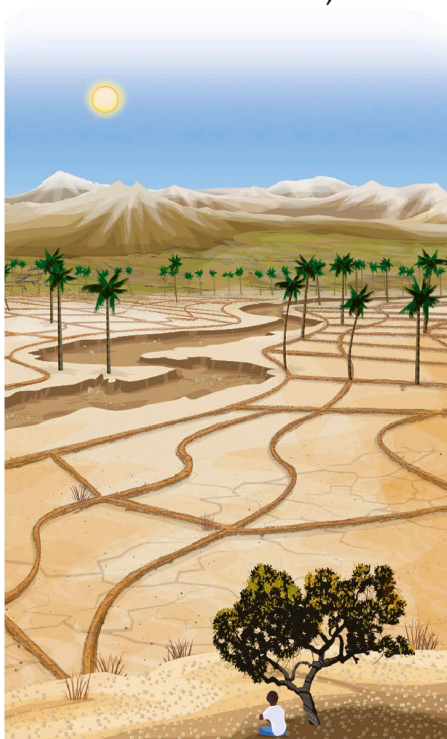
A monsoon is a seasonal wind that blows for about six months in one direction, then turns around and blows in the other direction for six months. In summer, moist winds from the ocean bring dark, rain-bearing clouds to the land. In winter, the cycle is reversed. Wind blows the air from the land to the sea, bringing cool, dry weather.



The monsoon areas are colored red.

Where the wind blows

The monsoon is best known in Asia, but monsoon winds also bring rain to other places in the tropics including Africa, South America, the southern United States, and Australia.



Before the monsoon

During the early summer, the hot Sun heats up the dry tropical land, while the seas and oceans stay cooler. As warm air rises above the land, cool, moist air from the sea rushes in to fill its place. The winds blowing the sea air bring heavy rainfall.